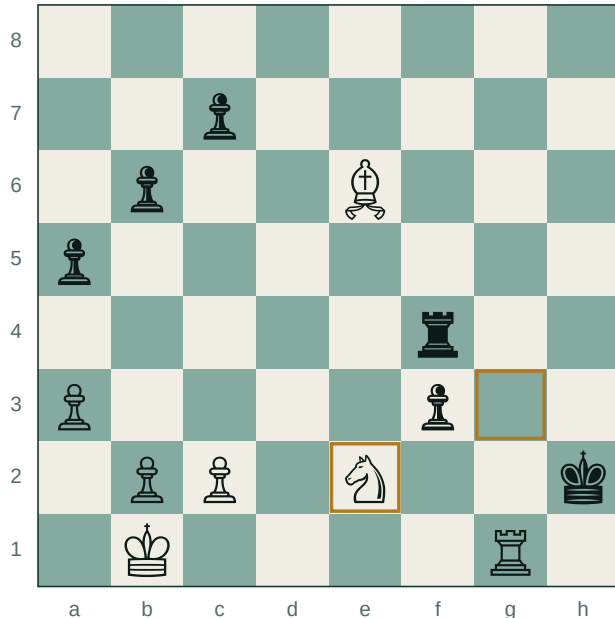


Pins and pressure: Black, move 59

Pins and pressure

Black to move



Previous move: 59.Ne2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

59...fxe2 60. Re1 Rf1 61. Kc1 Rxe1+

59...fxe2 The pawn captures the knight on e2. Recorded reply: **60.Re1**.

60...Rf1 The rook moves from f4 to f1. Recorded reply: **61.Kc1**.

61...Rxe1+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the rook on e1.

At the end, nominal material is White 6 / Black 9 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +8. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +8: the balance goes from -5 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on b1. Geometrically undefended: bishop on e6 and knight on e2. Check for tactical protection.